

Question ID: b6ebadf6

| Assessment | Test                | Domain              | Skill       | Difficulty                                        |
|------------|---------------------|---------------------|-------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| SAT        | Reading and Writing | Expression of Ideas | Transitions | Easy <div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |

**Question**

There are three basic steps you should follow when planning a scientific inquiry. First, thoroughly research the question you wish to answer. \_\_\_\_\_ come up with a prediction (also called a hypothesis) about the answer to your question. Third, develop an experiment that can test the accuracy of your hypothesis.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- Answer**
- A. Therefore,
  - B. Instead,
  - C. For example,
  - D. Second,

**Correct Answer: D**

**Rationale**

Choice D is the best answer. "Second" logically signals that the activity described in this sentence—coming up with a prediction—is the next step in the three-part sequence of steps described in the text.

Choice A is incorrect because "therefore" illogically signals that coming up with a prediction is a result or consequence of the activity described in the previous sentence: researching a question. While a prediction may be influenced by prior research, these activities are distinct steps in planning a scientific inquiry. Coming up with a prediction is the next step in the three-part sequence of steps described in the text. Choice B is incorrect because "instead" illogically signals that coming up with a prediction is an alternative to the activity described in the previous sentence: researching a question. Rather, coming up with a prediction is the next step in the three-part sequence of steps described in the text. Choice C is incorrect because "for example" illogically signals that coming up with a prediction is an example of the activity described in the previous sentence: researching a question. Instead, coming up with a prediction is the next step in the three-part sequence of steps described in the text.